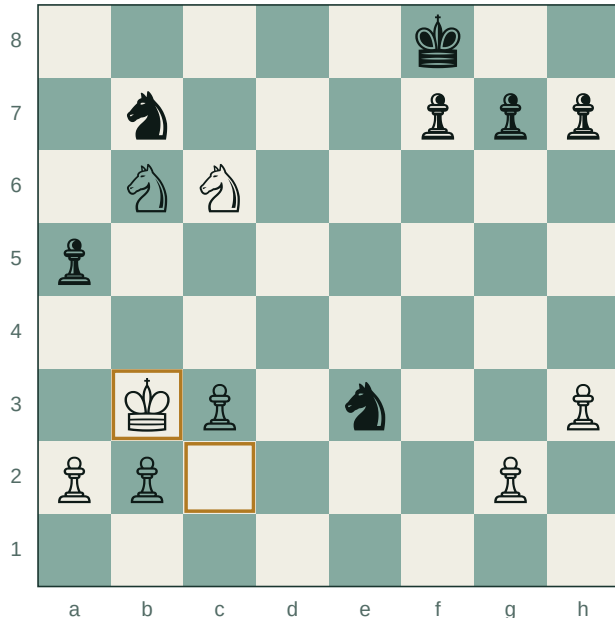


Knight-ending routes: Black, move 30

Knight-ending routes

Black to move



Previous move: 30.Kb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...Nc5+ 31. Ka3 Nc2#

30...Nc5+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **31.Ka3**.

31...Nc2# Mate: knight on c2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a3. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on c2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Knight endings reward exact route calculation. Forks can change a pawn race, while a distant passer may outrun the knight's short-range movement.

HOW TO LOOK

Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on b3. Geometrically undefended: knight on c6 and knight on b6. Check for tactical protection.